SOC-01 | Therapist only - all age groups

Expressing a need and keeping a boundary

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Clarify a need or boundary and choose whether and how to express it in a suitable context. Practice with the therapist without contacting the other person is possible. The aim is respectful expression and choice, not agreement at any cost.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Check power differences and safety before an actual conversation. Do not suggest practicing with someone threatening, harmful or coercive. Do not require contact, personal disclosure, reconciliation or apology; avoiding a conversation may be protective.

Reusing existing material

CORE-06 supports general problem solving. Here the focus is wording a need, request or boundary and allowing for a response other than agreement. Do not duplicate a family conversation plan or couples therapy.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

Which need, request or boundary was chosen?

2 | Question for discussion

What are the power differences, and is a conversation appropriate here?

3 | Question for discussion

What wording is clear, specific and respectful?

4 | Question for discussion

What options are available if the request is not accepted?

5 | Question for discussion

What are my limits on sharing, and what support do I need?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

Practice with a therapist or safe adult. A child must not be responsible for resolving power differences or a harmful situation alone.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Preserve choice about privacy and boundaries. Peer pressure does not require direct confrontation or a personal explanation.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Explore dependence, authority and possible costs of a request. Assertive expression does not guarantee a respectful response.

OA | Older adults

Allow preferences and choice of help. Do not assume a companion may speak for the participant.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Decide together whether practice between sessions is appropriate at all. Define one opportunity, boundaries, and desired support. Practice may take place only in the session. There is no required daily sequence or requirement to share the sheet with others.

At the next session

Ask whether the wording represented the person and respected their boundaries. Refusal does not mean practice failed. If threats or pressure arise, stop and explore support and an appropriate response instead of further refining the wording.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.cci.health.wa.gov.au/Resources/Looking-After-Yourself/Assertiveness

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